

Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

State compensation orders for forest personnel: comparative table of ten States

Death or injury in the line of duty | Position as on September 27, 2026

The ten States are grouped by the kind of instrument rather than alphabetically, because a dedicated forest order, a general employee scheme, a bank tie-up, and a staff-funded society are not comparable as a single list. The table covers only compensation to forest staff who die or are injured on duty.

State	Instrument, reference and date	Validity	Death	Permanent incapacitation and grievous hurt	Family livelihood (appointment, pension or other)	Coverage, triggers and remarks
A. Forest-specific orders for death or injury on duty <i>(the model orders for State outreach)</i>						
Maharashtra	Government Resolution No. FST-11/21/Pr. Kra. 248/F-4, Revenue and Forest Department. Dated October 12, 2022. Dr. Ravikiran Govekar, Chief Conservator of Forests (Mantralaya).	Standing order. No expiry or renewal.	Rs. 25 lakh, uniform for Groups A, B, C, and D. Paid as a fixed deposit in the joint names of the legal heirs, locked for 10 years; monthly interest payable; principal withdrawable after 5 years only in exceptional cases certified by the appointing authority.	Permanent disability: Rs. 3.60 lakh (Group A and above), Rs. 3.30 lakh (Group B), Rs. 3 lakh (Groups C and D). No separate head for grievous hurt.	Compassionate appointment; or, where no heir is eligible or willing, notional pay with every due promotion and annual increment, payable till the date the deceased would have superannuated.	Triggers: forest fire, wild-animal attack, attack by smugglers or poachers, and wildlife rescue. Also pays the full cost of transporting mortal remains with one escort, and full in-State medical and surgical costs. Applied in GO No. FST-05/26/Pr. Kra. 87/Vane-4 dated May 18, 2026.
Karnataka (forest staff)	Forest, Ecology and Environment Department: GO No. FEE o8 FNG 2019 dated June 5, 2020; GO No. FEE 95 FAP 2021 (Part-1) dated December 1, 2022; GO No. FEE 95 FAP 2021 dated October 3, 2023.	Standing orders. No expiry. Special Ex-Gratia Amount effective from August 9, 2018.	Rs. 60 lakh in aggregate: Rs. 50 lakh ex-gratia (2022 order) plus Rs. 10 lakh Special Ex-Gratia Amount paid in place of special group insurance (2023 order). Welfare-scheme (Kshemabhivruddhi) and temporary or seasonal employees: Rs. 5 lakh Special Ex-Gratia Amount only.	Permanent disablement: Rs. 10 lakh. Grievous injury: Rs. 2 lakh. Both at June 5, 2020 levels. The PCCF proposal to raise them to Rs. 20 lakh and Rs. 10 lakh was not accepted in 2022.	Not provided in these orders.	Covers Range Forest Officer, Deputy Range Forest Officer, Forest Guard, Vehicle Driver, Forest Watcher or Watchman, and elephant management staff. Extension to ACF and above, IFS, and SFS officers was sought and not granted. Trigger: death or injury on duty; human threats are not named.
Madhya Pradesh	Forest Department order No. F-1/2/7/0002/2023/Sec-1-10, Bhopal. Dated October 6, 2023. Signed Ashok Kumar, Additional Secretary. Supersedes order No. F 3-01/1999/10-1 dated June 27, 2008 (Rs. 10 lakh).	Standing order. No expiry.	Rs. 25 lakh special ex-gratia to dependants (raised from Rs. 10 lakh). Personnel killed protecting forests and wildlife are declared martyrs (shaheed).	Not provided.	Not provided.	All forest personnel killed protecting forests and wildlife; no cadre grading. A single-point enhancement order, silent on disability, medical costs, transport of remains, and appointment.
Telangana	G.O.Ms.No.43, Environment, Forest, Science and Technology (FOR-II) Department. Dated April 3, 2023. Signed Santhi Kumari, Chief Secretary and Special Chief Secretary (Forests).	Standing order. No expiry.	By cadre: Forest Beat Officer: Rs. 30 lakh Forest Section Officer / Deputy Range Officer: Rs. 45 lakh Forest Range Officer: Rs. 50 lakh ACF / DCF: Rs. 75 lakh IFS officers: Rs. 1 crore	Permanent incapacitation: Rs. 20, 25, 30, 40, and 50 lakh for the five cadre groups. Grievous hurt: Rs. 3, 5, 5, 5, and 6 lakh.	Not provided.	Trigger: death or injury caused by extremist or anti-social elements while protecting the forest; expressly on par with the police. Does not cover wild-animal attack, forest fire, or accident. Cadre grading pays the least to the ranks most exposed.

State	Instrument, reference and date	Validity	Death	Permanent incapacitation and grievous hurt	Family livelihood (appointment, pension or other)	Coverage, triggers and remarks
B. General State employee schemes <i>(forest staff covered only as State employees; fallback precedents)</i>						
Odisha	Finance Department Resolution No. FIN-GS2-MISC-0040-2023/1670 2/F. Dated June 7, 2023. Under the Orissa Civil Services (Compassionate Grant) Rules, 1964.	Revised rates effective May 22, 2023. Continuing.	Rs. 10 lakh on death while on duty (raised from Rs. 4 lakh).	Permanent incapacitation: Rs. 5 lakh (from Rs. 2 lakh). Partial incapacitation: Rs. 2 lakh (from Rs. 1 lakh).	Special family pension at last pay drawn till notional superannuation, but only for those who joined before January 1, 2005. Most present frontline staff are excluded.	All State Government employees; not forest-specific. The revision followed a meeting of May 26, 2023 attended by the PCCF (HoFF) and the Chief Wildlife Warden.
Assam	Finance (Estt-A) Department Notification No. FEG. 28/2017/26, Dispur. Dated September 14, 2017. Compassionate Family Pension (CFP) Scheme.	Deaths on or after April 1, 2017. Continuing.	No lump sum.	Not covered.	Family pension at 100% of last basic pay with Dearness Relief till deemed superannuation; then 50% till the deceased's notional age of 67; then normal family pension. Compassionate appointment abolished.	Any death in service, natural or unnatural, on or off duty. Not duty-linked. Covers State, provincialised, and NPS employees, and All India Services officers on the Assam cadre, including IFS. Minimum one year of continuous service.
Himachal Pradesh	Finance (IF) Department Notification No. Fin-IF-(F)9-5/2012-II, Shimla. Dated November 17, 2025. Group Personal Accident Insurance Scheme (compulsory).	November 18, 2025 to November 17, 2026. Renewed annually.	Rs. 5 lakh on accidental death. Natural death not covered.	Permanent total disablement: Rs. 5 lakh. Loss of one limb and one eye: Rs. 5 lakh. Loss of one limb or one eye: Rs. 2 lakh.	None.	Widest category coverage on file: regular, adhoc, part-time, contractual, and daily-waged employees. Accidents at any time and place, including drowning, floods, landslides, snakebite, earthquake, and cyclone. Premium Rs. 200 a year, deducted from salary.
C. Salary-account bank tie-ups <i>(large cover at no cost to the State exchequer)</i>						
Tamil Nadu	G.O.(MS) No.113, Finance (Treasuries and Accounts-III) Department. Dated May 14, 2025. Gives effect to the Budget Speech of March 14, 2025.	Through bank MoUs for 2025-26; continuation depends on renewal.	Personal accident cover Rs. 1 crore on accidental death. Term life cover Rs. 10 lakh on natural death in service.	Rs. 1 crore on permanent disability from accident.	For families of employees who die in accidents: marriage assistance of Rs. 5 lakh per daughter (up to Rs. 10 lakh); higher-education assistance up to Rs. 10 lakh; loan interest concessions.	All State employees with salary accounts at seven participating banks (SBI, Indian Bank, Indian Overseas Bank, Axis Bank, Bank of Baroda, Union Bank of India, and Canara Bank). Free of cost to employees and the State.
Rajasthan	MoU between the Rajasthan Forest Department and Bank of Baroda under the Baroda Defence and Police Salary Package (SB186). Executed at Jaipur on September 24, 2025.	Three years from September 24, 2025. The bank may modify or withdraw benefits without notice (clause 9).	Serving staff: accident death Rs. 1.25 crore, on or off duty; life cover Rs. 10 lakh. Pensioners: accident death Rs. 50 lakh.	Serving staff: permanent total disability Rs. 1.25 crore; partial up to Rs. 62.50 lakh. Pensioners: Rs. 50 lakh and up to Rs. 25 lakh.	None. Ancillary card covers (Rs. 10 lakh and Rs. 20 lakh), salary overdraft, and family accounts.	Forest Department salaried staff and pensioners holding SB186 accounts, aged 18 to 60. Claim proceeds are first set off against dues to the bank. Free of cost to employees and the State.
D. Departmental self-funded scheme <i>(financed by employee subscriptions; no State liability)</i>						

State	Instrument, reference and date	Validity	Death	Permanent incapacitation and grievous hurt	Family livelihood (appointment, pension or other)	Coverage, triggers and remarks
Andhra Pradesh	Memo No. EFS01-FRSToFSER/50/2023-SE C-V, Environment, Forests, Science and Technology (Sec.V) Department. Dated September 30, 2023. Permits SANJEEVANI, the AP Forest Department Employees' Benevolent and Thrift Deposit Fund.	Bye-laws in force from December 1, 2023. Amounts alterable by the society's General Body.	From the Fund, on death in service: Rs. 5 lakh (Category A, Rs. 500 monthly subscription) or Rs. 10 lakh (Category B, Rs. 1,000 monthly). Accidental death: further group insurance of Rs. 5 lakh or Rs. 10 lakh. Subscriptions refunded with interest.	No provision.	None. Concessional loans; outstanding loans written off on death.	Not a State compensation order. The Government expressly bears no financial commitment, now or in future. Regular employees only; daily-waged, contractual, and casual staff, including fire watchers, are excluded. Death need not be duty-linked.

Notes

1. Best order

Maharashtra, Government Resolution dated October 12, 2022, on design rather than amount. It is the only order that combines a uniform lump sum for all Groups, a disability head, continued family income till superannuation, transport of mortal remains, and medical costs, under triggers that match how frontline staff actually die. Its weakness is the disability amount of Rs. 3 lakh to Rs. 3.60 lakh.

3. Widest coverage

- **Employee categories: Himachal Pradesh.** The only instrument reaching daily-waged and contractual staff, though its amount is the lowest on file.
- **Causes of death: Assam and Himachal Pradesh.** Assam covers any death in service; Himachal covers any accident at any time. Telangana is the narrowest.
- **Amount: Karnataka and Telangana among State-funded orders.** **Karnataka pays Rs. 60 lakh to frontline staff; Telangana pays Rs. 30 lakh to Rs. 1 crore by cadre.**
- **The bank tie-ups of Rajasthan (Rs. 1.25 crore) and Tamil Nadu (Rs. 1 crore) are higher but are not State-funded.**

4. Model standard that other States can adopt

Element	Drawn from	Proposed standard
Death lump sum	Maharashtra; Karnataka; Telangana	Same amount for every cadre. Rs. 25 lakh is the lowest existing benchmark; Karnataka (Rs. 60 lakh) and Telangana (up to Rs. 1 crore) show that higher amounts are achievable.
Permanent incapacitation	Telangana; Karnataka	A separate amount of roughly half to two-thirds of the death benefit, not a token sum.
Grievous hurt	Telangana; Karnataka	A separate head of its own.
Family livelihood	Maharashtra; Assam	Compassionate appointment, or full pay with notional promotions till superannuation.
Triggers	Maharashtra; Telangana; Himachal Pradesh	Forest fire, wild animals, smugglers or poachers, extremist or anti-social elements, rescue operations, and accidents on duty.
Staff covered	Himachal Pradesh	All field staff, including daily-waged and contractual workers such as fire watchers.
Incidentals	Maharashtra	Transport of mortal remains with one escort, and full medical costs.

Element	Drawn from	Proposed standard
Protecting the payout	Maharashtra	Fixed deposit in the heirs' joint names.
Duration	Maharashtra; Telangana; Karnataka	A standing order with no expiry.
Zero-cost top-up	Tamil Nadu; Rajasthan	Accident cover of Rs. 1 crore or more through salary-account bank tie-ups.
Relation to existing schemes	Lesson from Assam and Odisha	Paid over and above any existing pension or compassionate grant, since appointment and special family pension are not available everywhere.